

# JOSH NYKAMP

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## CHIEF TECHNOLOGY OFFICER | VICE PRESIDENT OF ENGINEERING

Turns complex technology organizations into scalable engines of speed, talent, and enterprise value.

**Engineering executive with 15 years of success** commanding technology strategy, organizational transformation, and product delivery across regulated, high scale consumer platforms. Proven force in building elite teams, integrating acquired organizations, modernizing architecture, and converting engineering investment into measurable growth. Drove AI native development across five teams to cut cycle time by 30% and launched product lines producing more than \$3M in incremental ARR. Combines hands on command of high concurrency systems with the organizational discipline to accelerate startups, scale platforms, and lead through rapid change.

**Engineering Organization Design • Technology Strategy • AI Native SDLC • Mergers and Acquisitions Integration  
Platform Architecture • DevOps & CI/CD • Cloud Infrastructure • Product Engineering • Enterprise Architecture  
High Concurrency Systems • Talent Acquisition & Retention • Regulatory Compliance • Site Reliability Engineering**

### CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- ✓ **Scaled engineering from 11 to more than 70 professionals with zero regrettable attrition and 20 referral hires**, combining organizational design and talent acquisition to help position Jackpocket for its \$750M acquisition by DraftKings.
- ✓ **Cut infrastructure costs by 50%** while establishing the largest production Elixir organization in the US, building a comprehensive training program and leveraging Elixir's concurrency model and fault tolerance to scale high-traffic systems efficiently
- ✓ **Transformed deployment cadence from 1–2 monthly releases to hundreds of deployments per month within six months**, implementing progressive delivery, guarded releases, and a roll-forward incident response strategy.

### PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

#### DRAFTKINGS, FORMERLY JACKPOCKET | REMOTE | JANUARY 2024 TO PRESENT

##### SENIOR DIRECTOR OF ENGINEERING

Retained following the \$750M acquisition to lead engineering integration and continued product development for the DraftKings lottery vertical. Directed 50 engineers across 5 teams after right sizing the 70 person Jackpocket organization.

##### *Selected Achievements & Impact:*

- Completed engineering role evaluation and functional reallocation within three months by integrating 70 positions and moving SRE, security, and QA talent into shared DraftKings verticals.
- Reduced engineering cycle time by 30% by deploying Claude, Gemini, and GitHub Copilot across planning, story authoring, development, and debugging workflows.
- Generated \$3M in incremental ARR by launching keno and scaling scratch off ticket products across five states.
- Consolidated three contractor relationships into one internal capability by founding and staffing a six person hardware engineering team for automated lottery and scratch off dispensing machines.
- Modernized ticket discovery and segmentation by replacing a Tesseract-based OCR pipeline with a self-hosted Qwen vision model, reducing adaptation to ticket-format changes from days of engineering work to little or no code changes.

#### JACKPOCKET | REMOTE | JANUARY 2021 TO DECEMBER 2023

##### VICE PRESIDENT OF ENGINEERING

Recruited to restructure and scale engineering for a mobile lottery platform operating within a heavily regulated environment. Reported to the CTO and partnered with the CEO on organizational planning, headcount strategy, and engineering investment.

##### *Selected Achievements & Impact:*

- Expanded engineering from 11 to more than 70 engineers, three SREs, two security engineers, and five engineering managers by activating trusted networks that produced 20 referral hires with zero regrettable attrition.

- Doubled product velocity by restructuring a monolithic organization into dedicated ecommerce and fulfillment teams with independent backlogs, ownership, and release cycles.
- Transformed delivery from 1–2 releases per month to continuous deployment within six months, embedding DevSecOps practices including automated CI/CD, static code analysis, secret scanning, feature flags, and progressive delivery..
- Established the fulfillment platform that enabled scratch-off tickets as a scalable product line, orchestrating ticket ordering, activation, automated scratching and scanning, winner validation, and ML-based ticket-to-customer matching.

#### WEEDMAPS | IRVINE, CA | OCTOBER 2016 TO JUNE 2021

##### DIRECTOR OF ENGINEERING | SEPTEMBER 2019 TO JUNE 2021

Promoted to establish Weedmaps Exchange, a business to business wholesale marketplace connecting growers, processors, and dispensaries across regulated cannabis markets. Held broader accountability for a 45 person engineering division spanning 5 teams.

##### **Selected Achievements & Impact:**

- Created \$3M in monthly GMV within six months by hiring 13 engineers and building the Exchange platform from the ground up across California, Oklahoma, and Michigan.
- Enabled distributed execution across five teams by directing 45 engineers and coordinating nearshore staff augmentation in Costa Rica and Colombia.
- Standardized titles, leveling, and performance management during companywide growth from 50 to 211 engineers by authoring the Engineering Career Ladder and review process.

##### ENGINEERING MANAGER | AUGUST 2017 TO SEPTEMBER 2019

Elevated to lead engineering delivery for logistics products and foundational platform modernization. Combined product execution, architecture leadership, and technical enablement to support rapid expansion.

##### **Selected Achievements & Impact:**

- Enabled hundreds of thousands of deliveries annually by building and launching Weedmaps Logistics with Android and iOS driver applications and a web dispatch interface.
- Halved infrastructure costs by piloting Elixir as the replacement for Ruby on Rails and building the training model that established the largest production Elixir organization in the United States.

##### SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER | OCTOBER 2016 TO AUGUST 2017

Brought in to restore technical control over an unmaintainable legacy platform and establish a modern application foundation. Championed Elixir, Phoenix, and React as the core architecture for future products.

##### **Selected Achievements & Impact:**

- Created the foundation for three new product lines by diagnosing a minified PHP codebase with no recoverable repository and executing a complete rebuild in Elixir.
- Established the architecture for the migration to Elixir, standardizing new services on Elixir and Phoenix with REST APIs for frontend integration and RabbitMQ for asynchronous service-to-service communication.

#### EARLIER EXPERIENCE

**Senior Software Engineer**, NBC via Gorilla Logic • **Software Engineer**, TalentReef • **Software Engineer**, I Behavior • **Software Engineer**, New Frontier Media

#### MILITARY SERVICE

**Avionics Technician & Rescue Swimmer** | United States Navy

#### EDUCATION

General Studies | Santa Barbara City College

#### TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Languages & Frameworks:** Elixir • Phoenix • Ruby on Rails • Python • Node.js • GraphQL • React • Next.js • Apollo

**Cloud & DevOps:** AWS • Google Cloud Platform • GitHub Actions • Argo • Docker • LaunchDarkly

**Artificial Intelligence:** Claude • Gemini • Qwen • GitHub Copilot

**Platforms & Operations:** RabbitMQ • Datadog • StrongDM • Jira

**Mobile Engineering:** iOS • Android